To start, I'll talk a little about why you need Tag Helpers when Razor can already generate any HTML you like by combining C# and HTML in a file.

## *18.1 Catering to editors with Tag Helpers*

One of the common complaints about the mixture of C# and HTML in Razor templates is that you can't easily use standard HTML editing tools with them; all the `@` and `{}` symbols in the C# code tend to confuse the editors. Reading the templates can be similarly difficult for people; switching paradigms between C# and HTML can be a bit jarring sometimes.

This arguably wasn't such a problem when Visual Studio was the only supported way to build ASP.NET websites, as it could obviously understand the templates without any problems and helpfully colorize the editor. But with ASP.NET Core going cross-platform, the desire to play nicely with other editors reared its head again.

This was one of the big motivations for Tag Helpers. They integrate seamlessly into the standard HTML syntax by adding what look to be attributes, typically starting with `asp-*`. They're most often used to generate HTML forms, as shown in the following listing. This listing shows a view from the first iteration of the currency converter application, in which you choose the currencies and quantity to convert.

**Listing 18.1 User registration form using Tag Helpers**

```
@page                                                          ❶
@model ConvertModel                                            ❶
<form method="post">
    <div class="form-group">
        <label asp-for="CurrencyFrom"></label>                 ❷
        <input class="form-control" asp-for="CurrencyFrom" />  ❸
        <span asp-validation-for="CurrencyFrom"></span>        ❹
    </div>
    <div class="form-group">
        <label asp-for="Quantity"></label>                     ❷
```